

Academic Performance Task, Expectations and Rubric

The Task

Students are to investigate the areas of mineral exploration in Canada. Choose from building materials, coal, diamonds, metals, non—metals, peat, or uranium and begin to explore where they would establish a new mine site. In their proposal, students are to justify their site selection and the type of mine they are proposing. The proposal will outline: how the resource will be developed and refined in order to meet the requirements imposed by governments, how it will get to the market, environmental and wildlife concerns and the impact on the local residents. Students are instructed to include supporting visuals, such as maps, graphs, charts, diagrams or pictures, in their proposals.

Expectations

This task gives students the opportunity to demonstrate achievement of the following selected expectations from three strands: Geographic Foundations: Space and Systems; Human-Environment Interactions; and Methods of Geographic Inquiry.

Students will:

1. explain the geographical requirements that determine the location of businesses, industries, and transportation systems, and make predictions about future locations of these enterprises and systems;
2. demonstrate an understanding of how natural systems (e.g., climate, soils, landforms, wildlife) influence cultural and economic activities (e.g., recreation, transportation, employment opportunities);
3. demonstrate an understanding of the methods used to collect, organize, manipulate, and interpret geographic data;
4. locate and use effectively geographic material from primary sources (e.g., field research, surveys, interviews) and secondary sources (e.g., mainstream and alternative media, CD-ROMs, Internet) to research a geographic issue;
5. select and use appropriate methods for displaying geographic data;
6. create and use effectively photographs, charts, graphs, models, and diagrams;
7. use geographic data to support conclusions and opinions;
8. use cartographic conventions correctly when constructing maps (e.g., scale, legend, direction);
9. use graphic organizers (e.g. semantic webs, timelines, future wheels, analogy charts, Venn diagrams) effectively to visualize, clarify, and interpret geographic information.

Prior Knowledge and Skills

To complete this task, students are expected to be able to demonstrate the following:

- an understanding of the rock cycle
- explain the importance of mining in Canada
- describe the steps used by mining companies to discover and develop an ore body
- explain some issues facing Canada's mining industry
- an understanding of research methods using a variety of source materials
- ability to use graphic organizers
- ability to read, analyse, and interpret graphs and maps
- ability to use a variety of tools and technologies for research.

Task Rubric – Proposal for a New Mine						
Expectations	Criteria	Level 1 (50 – 59)	Level 2 (60 –69)	Level 3 (70 – 79)	Level 4 (80 -100)	
<u>Knowledge / understanding</u>						
2	Demonstrates an understanding of the methods used to collect, organize, manipulate, and interpret geographic data	Demonstrates little understanding of the methods used to collect, organize, manipulate, and interpret geographic data	Demonstrates some understanding of the methods used to collect, organize, manipulate, and interpret geographic data	Demonstrates considerable understanding of the methods used to collect, organize, manipulate, and interpret geographic data	Demonstrates an understanding of the methods used to collect, organize, manipulate, and interpret geographic data to a high degree	
<u>Thinking / Inquiry</u>						
3	Locates and uses effectively geographic material from primary and secondary sources to research a geographic issue	Locates and uses effectively geographic material from primary and secondary sources to research a geographic issue to a little degree	Locates and uses effectively geographic material from primary and secondary sources to research a geographic issue to some degree	Locates and uses effectively geographic material from primary and secondary sources to research a geographic issue to a considerable degree	Locates and uses effectively geographic material from primary and secondary sources to research a geographic issue to a high degree	
<u>Communication</u>						
1,4,5	- Explains the geographical requirements that determine the location of a mine - Selects and uses appropriate methods for displaying geographic data; - Creates and uses effectively photographs, charts, graphs, models, and diagrams	- Offers little explanation of the geographical requirements that determine the location of a mine - Selects and uses few methods for displaying geographic data; - Creates and uses few photographs, charts, graphs, models, and diagrams	- Offers some explanation of the geographical requirements that determine the location of a mine - Selects and uses some methods for displaying geographic data; - Creates and uses some photographs, charts, graphs, models, and diagrams	- Explains the geographical requirements that determine the location of a mine to a considerable degree - Selects and uses considerable methods for displaying geographic data; - Creates and uses a considerable number of photographs, charts, graphs, models, and diagrams	- Explains the geographical requirements that determine the location of a mine to a high degree - Selects and uses methods for displaying geographic data to a high degree - Creates and uses photographs, charts, graphs, models, and diagrams to a high degree	
<u>Application</u>						
6	Uses geographic data to support conclusions and opinions	Uses geographic data to support conclusions and opinions to a small degree	Uses geographic data to support conclusions and opinions to some degree	Uses geographic data to support conclusions and opinions to a considerable degree	Uses geographic data to support conclusions and opinions to a high degree	